Step 1: Download the ZIP File from Blackboard

1. **Log in to Blackboard:** Access to module's Blackboard page.
2. **Navigate to the Assessment:** Go to the section of your Blackboard course where the mock practical exercise is located.
3. **Locate the ZIP File:** Look for a link or attachment named something like "Lab-Based-Practical-2025-Mock.zip" (the exact name may vary slightly). It should be clearly identified as a ZIP file.
4. **Download:** Click on the link or attachment to download the ZIP file. Your browser will typically prompt you to choose a download location. Save the file to a location you'll easily remember, such as your "Downloads" folder, "Desktop,", etc. *Make a note of where you save the file.*

Step 2: Import the ZIP File into NetBeans

1. **Open NetBeans:** Launch the NetBeans IDE.
2. **Import Project:**
    - Go to `File` -> `Import Project` -> `From ZIP`. This is the *correct* way to import a project from a ZIP file in NetBeans. *Do not* use "Open Project" directly on the ZIP file; this will not properly import the project structure.
    - Alternatively, you may find "Import Project" section in the project explorer, click on it. Select `From Zip`.
3. **Select the ZIP File:**
    - A file selection dialog will appear.
    - Navigate to the location where you downloaded the ZIP file (from Step 1).
    - Select the ZIP file (e.g., "Lab-Based-Practical-2025-Mock.zip").
    - Click the "Import" button (the button name might be "Open" in some NetBeans versions).

Step 3: Implement the Project

- You have been provided with instructions, documentation and references to implement your codes (These documents will be also available in the actual test). Please note that the comments are also provided inside each class with detailed

information. Please feel free to follow eighter comments inside the codes or the instructions for each class.

- Please note that the actual test is a closed book. However, you will have access to the same references and materials that you have in the mock exercise.
- Please also note that the mock exercise is more complex and longer than the actual test and it is intended to fully prepare you for the actual test.

Step 4: Export the Project as a ZIP File (After Implementation)

1. **Clean and Build (Recommended):**
    - In NetBeans, right-click on the project in the "Projects" window (usually on the left side).
    - Select "Clean and Build". This removes any old compiled files and rebuilds the project from scratch, ensuring that your ZIP file contains the latest, correct versions of your code.
2. **Export to ZIP:**
    - Right-click on the project in the "Projects" window.
    - Select `Export Project` -> `To ZIP...`
3. **Choose ZIP Location and Name:**
    - A dialog box will appear.
    - **Browse:** Click the "Browse..." button to choose the location where you want to save the ZIP file. It is HIGHLY recommended putting it in a clear area, like your Desktop or a dedicated "Submissions" folder. *Do not just leave it in the default location; you might not find it easily.*
    - **ZIP Name:** The dialog will usually pre-fill the ZIP file name with the project name. You can modify this if needed, but it's generally best to keep the project name.
    - **Important: Add your details**. For instance: `YourName_StudentID_LabExercise.zip` This makes it clear who submitted the file.
4. **Click "Export":**

- Click the "Export" button to create the ZIP file. NetBeans will package your project (including all source files, project metadata, and potentially build output, depending on your project settings) into the specified ZIP file.

5. **Verify (Important!)**
    - *Locate the ZIP File*: Go to the folder where you saved the exported ZIP file (the one you chose in step 3).
    - *Check the Size*: Make sure the ZIP file has a reasonable size (more than just a few kilobytes). A very small ZIP file might indicate that something went wrong during the export.
    - *Optional (Highly Recommended):* Create a *new, empty folder*. Extract the ZIP file *into this new folder*. Open the extracted project in NetBeans (using File -> Open Project). This verifies that the ZIP file contains a valid, openable NetBeans project. This step helps ensure that you don't accidentally submit an empty or corrupted ZIP file.